

The Duality Argument for a Non-Contingent Mind

A Deductive Contingency Argument

James (JD) Longmire

ORCID: 0009-0009-1383-7698

Northrop Grumman Fellow (unaffiliated research)

Correspondence: jdlongmire@outlook.com

Abstract

This paper presents the Duality Argument, a deductive case for the existence of a non-contingent, volitional Mind as the only sufficient metaphysical ground for an intelligible reality. The argument proceeds through rigorous elimination in three stages. First, drawing from Kurt Gödel's Incompleteness Theorems, it establishes that all complex formal systems, and by extension, the physical cosmos they describe, are necessarily contingent, relying on unprovable foundations. Second, it posits that this contingent reality is characterized by two inseparable features: static logical/mathematical order and dynamic physical actuation. Third, it argues that any candidate for a non-contingent ground must be able to account for both features. Through systematic elimination, it demonstrates that purely static grounds (e.g., Platonism) and purely dynamic grounds (e.g., materialism) necessarily fail this test, as does Pantheism, which merely repackages the contingency it purports to explain. The paper concludes deductively that "Mind" (as the only ontological category that inherently unifies rational order [Intellect] and executive actuation [Will]) is the sole candidate that can serve as the necessary, non-contingent ground for reality.

1. The Problem of Contingency: Gödel's Contribution

The 20th-century logician Kurt Gödel revolutionized mathematics by proving that any formal system complex enough to express basic arithmetic is necessarily incomplete (Gödel, 1931). His theorems demonstrate that such systems cannot prove their own consistency; they are, in effect, contingent upon a set of foundational axioms that must be accepted without proof from within the system itself.

This logical contingency provides important support for what we will call the Duality Argument. Gödel's work extends deeper than mathematics, as the axioms of arithmetic are themselves contingent upon a more primitive "operating system": the fundamental laws of logic (Identity, Non-Contradiction, and Excluded Middle). These laws are the preconditions for any intelligible system (Aristotle, *Metaphysics* IV).

Our investigation begins here, for this same contingency applies to physical reality. The cosmos, as described by physics, is a profoundly logical and mathematical system. Yet, like a formal system, it cannot account for itself. Its existence is a "brute fact" or, like arithmetic, it is contingent upon some prior principle (Leibniz, 1714).

Crucially, physical reality does not merely "follow" or "can be described by" mathematics. It **literally implements** formal mathematical operations. Computers perform arithmetic calculations. DNA encodes and processes information according to mathematical principles. Chemical bonds follow precise mathematical rules for energy minimization. Quantum systems implement complex number operations. This is not metaphor; these are actual instantiations of formal systems within physical reality.

Because the physical universe implements systems capable of expressing arithmetic, it inherits the limitations Gödel proved apply to such systems. The universe cannot validate its own mathematical consistency from within itself (Penrose, 1989). Yet throughout cosmic history, mathematics has worked reliably, and no logical contradictions have actualized in physical processes. This reliability requires explanation that cannot come from within the system itself.

2. The Duality of Contingent Reality

This contingent reality presents itself to us with two fundamental and inseparable characteristics:

Static Logical Order: The universe adheres to a fixed, immutable logical and mathematical structure. The laws of logic are inviolable. Even in quantum mechanics, superposition does not violate logic; it is a distinct logical state that our classical intuition fails to grasp. The universe is a "logical" system governed by what physicist Eugene Wigner called the "unreasonable effectiveness of mathematics" (Wigner, 1960).

Dynamic Actuation: The universe is not a static blueprint; it is an event. It is the continuous "act of being" of quantum fields, energy, and matter. It is characterized by change, motion, and temporality. Physical reality is dynamic actualization.

The central problem of metaphysics is this: If contingent reality is the effect, its cause must be able to account for both of these features. We must find a non-contingent ground (to avoid an infinite regress) that is the source of both static logic and dynamic action.

These two features are inseparable because neither can exist alone. Static logical order without dynamic actuation is pure abstraction with no instantiation: it cannot explain why anything exists. Dynamic actuation without static logical order would be ontological chaos: all possible states actualizing simultaneously without governance or constraint. Yet we observe neither pure abstraction nor pure chaos. We observe ordered, law-governed, dynamic reality.

Illustration from Modern Physics: The Lagrangian Duality

A striking example of this duality appears in the Lagrangian formulation of physics. In classical and quantum field theories, the evolution of a physical system is governed by a Lagrangian function, which unifies two inseparable features:

Static rational order: The Lagrangian encapsulates the symmetries, conservation laws, and mathematical structure of the system. These are expressions of immutable rational order, often described through Noether's theorem, which links symmetry to conservation.

Dynamic actuation: The principle of least action selects a single path of evolution from among infinite possible trajectories. This principle is not merely descriptive; it governs which possibility is realized.

The Lagrangian does not simply describe physical behavior; it **prescribes** the actualization of a specific path in a space of possibilities. But this selective actuation introduces the very metaphysical problem the Duality Argument targets: what grounds the selection? Why does this specific Lagrangian structure exist rather than another? Why does the principle of least action actualize one trajectory and not another?

If physical reality is contingent, and the Lagrangian formalism implements both rational order and dynamic selection, then the need for a unified, non-contingent ground is pressed even more sharply. The Lagrangian is

a case study in duality (rational blueprint and executive governance inseparably joined) pointing directly to the metaphysical necessity of Mind.

3. A Filter for the Non-Contingent Ground

To avoid the infinite regress of contingent causes, we must posit a non-contingent source: an entity defined by *aseity*, or self-existence (Aquinas, *Summa Theologica* I, q.2, a.3). This entity is the "ground floor" of all being.

Our filter for this entity is clear: **It must inherently and unitively explain both logical order and dynamic action.**

Let us test the primary metaphysical candidates against this filter.

3.1. The Failure of Static Grounds (e.g., Platonism, Neoplatonism)

This model posits a static, impersonal ground (such as the Platonic "realm of Forms" or the Neoplatonic "One") as the non-contingent source (Plato, *Republic* VI-VII; Plotinus, *Enneads* I.7).

As Logic: This candidate successfully grounds static logical order. The Forms or "The One" are the source of all rational structure. Abstract mathematical truths exist in this realm.

As Action: This candidate fails. A perfect, static, simple, and impersonal "One" has no principle of action. There is no mechanism or reason for it to "do" anything, such as "emanate" or "create" a contingent universe. Pure abstraction is causally inert. It provides no "engine" for the dynamic actuation we observe. As Swinburne notes, "a timeless abstract object can have no causal powers" (Swinburne, 2004).

3.2. The Failure of Dynamic Grounds (e.g., Pantheism, Materialism)

This model posits a dynamic, "brute fact" ground. In its pantheistic form, the universe is the non-contingent entity (Spinoza's "God or Nature"). In its materialist form, the quantum fields are the "brute fact" ground.

As Action: This candidate successfully grounds dynamic action. The universe is the action itself.

As Logic: This candidate fails on two counts.

First, it provides no solution to the contingency problem. A "brute" action cannot explain the profound logical and mathematical order of reality. The universe began a finite time ago. Its physical constants could have been different. Its quantum states are contingent. Declaring these contingent features "necessary" by identifying them with God does not make them actually necessary.

Second, Pantheism merely identifies the "non-contingent" with the sum total of contingent things (the universe). This is a fallacy of composition. An infinite chain of contingent parts is still contingent; it is the infinite regress itself, not the solution to it (Pruss, 2006). Pantheism doesn't provide an external ground; it identifies the ground with the thing needing grounding.

Third, insofar as Spinozistic pantheism posits necessary emanation of modes from substance (Spinoza, 1677), it cannot account for genuinely contingent reality. Necessary causes produce necessary effects. Yet the universe exhibits genuine contingency: it could have been otherwise or not at all. Only volitional actuation can produce contingent states from a necessary being.

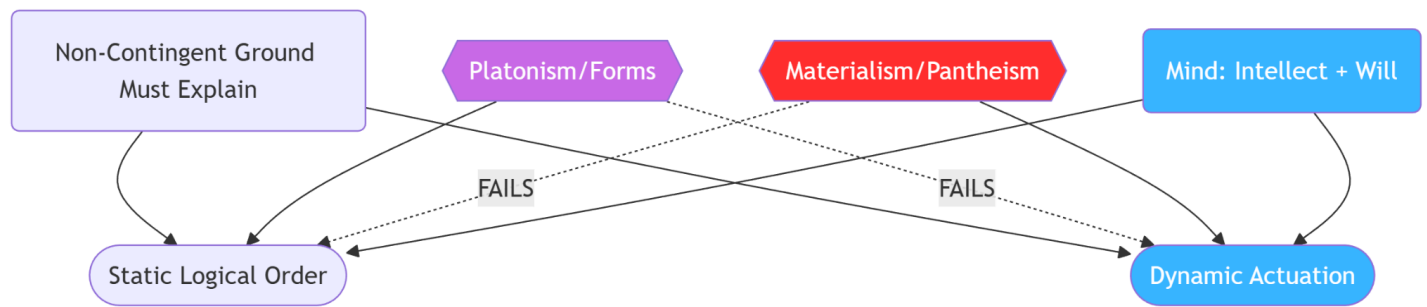


Figure 1: The Duality Filter. Any candidate for the non-contingent ground must pass both tests. Purely static grounds (Platonism, Neoplatonism) lack a principle of actuation. Purely dynamic grounds (Materialism, Pantheism) lack intrinsic rational order. Only Mind, which intrinsically unifies rational order (Intellect) with executive actuation (Will), passes both requirements.

4. The Inference to a Non-Contingent Mind

Both static and dynamic grounds have failed. The static model lacks an engine, and the dynamic model lacks a blueprint. We are forced to conclude that the non-contingent source must be an entity that is the inherent, living unity of both.

We must ask: What ontological category is defined by the unity of static logic and dynamic action?

The answer is **Mind**.

Intellect (Static Logic): A mind is a "place" for rational order. It understands immutable truths (like logic and mathematics). It grasps necessary relationships and eternal principles. This is its "static" component (not static in the sense of being inert, but in the sense of comprehending what is necessarily and eternally true).

Will (Dynamic Action): A mind possesses a "source of action" called volition. It can freely choose to "actualize" a contingent reality (like an idea) in accordance with its rational understanding. Will is the principle of executive actuation: the power to bring potential into actuality.

This volitional nature is not optional but necessary to explain contingent reality. If the non-contingent ground's actuation were itself necessary (as in Neoplatonic emanation or Spinozistic modes), then the resulting states would be necessary consequences, not genuinely contingent. But we observe contingent reality: states that could have been otherwise. The physical constants could have had different values. The universe could have not existed at all. For genuinely contingent states to obtain from a necessary being, the actuating principle must be capable of selecting among real alternatives. This is precisely what Will means: the power to choose which possibilities to actualize from among multiple genuine options. Necessary emanation produces necessary effects; only volitional actuation produces contingent ones (Swinburne, 2004).

Therefore, "Mind" is the only concept that passes our filter. It is a single entity that intrinsically unites a "blueprint" (Intellect) with a "builder" (Will). As Thomas Aquinas argued, intellect and will are necessarily unified in personal being (Aquinas, *Summa Theologica* I, q.14-19).

If the non-contingent ground must be a unity of logic and action, and the only known unity of logic and action is Mind, the conclusion is that the non-contingent ground must be a non-contingent Mind.

4.1. The Label Game and the Absence of Genuine Counter-Examples

A recurring strategy against this conclusion is to propose alternative metaphysical ultimates (such as Aristotle's self-thinking thought, Whitehead's dipolar God, absolute idealism's self-differentiating Absolute, neutral-monist proto-experience, or various forms of necessity-of-nature theories) and then insist that the argument has not "ruled them out."

These are serious philosophical traditions developed by brilliant thinkers over millennia. Each deserves, and has received, extensive treatment in the literature. Our purpose here is not to provide comprehensive refutations, but to show that none of these positions, however sophisticated in their own domains, successfully passes the specific explanatory filter this argument establishes. Defenders of these positions will naturally contest these brief treatments; our claim is simply that the burden shifts to them to demonstrate how their proposal unifies rational order with volitional actuation without reducing to Mind.

This strategy fails for a simple reason: none of these candidates even attempts to satisfy the explanatory filter the argument establishes. When examined, they either (a) reduce to the very category of Mind the argument concludes to (often under different terminology), or (b) replicate one of the two failures already diagnosed: lacking a principle of executive actuation (static failures) or lacking intrinsic rational order (dynamic failures).

Examples:

Aristotle's Prime Mover is pure self-contemplation with no volitional actuation of contingent states (Aristotle, *Metaphysics* XII.7-9). It is the unmoved mover precisely because it does not will or choose to create. It moves by being the object of desire, not by executive action. This replicates the Platonic failure: rational order without dynamic actuation. Moreover, even if we grant that it "actuates" by final causation, this would be necessary emanation from its nature, incapable of producing genuinely contingent states that could have been otherwise.

Whitehead's process theology describes a dipolar ultimate with both primordial nature (the eternal, conceptual pole containing all possibilities) and consequent nature (the actualizing, physical pole responding to the world) (Whitehead, 1929). But this is precisely the intellect-will unity here identified as Mind. Whitehead has not avoided the conclusion; he has restated it in process metaphysics terminology.

Absolute Idealism (Bradley, 1893; Royce, 1899) posits a self-differentiating Absolute that encompasses all reality. But it offers no internal principle explaining why the Absolute differentiates into this specific contingent cosmos rather than remaining undifferentiated or differentiating differently. Without a principle of selective actuation (what classical theology calls Will), the theory cannot account for the particularity of contingent reality.

Neutral monism and panpsychism (Russell, 1921; Nagel, 2012) at best yield proto-rational, proto-dynamic features distributed across reality. They never produce a unified executive act that selects and sustains one coherent contingent order. "Proto-mental" is precisely that: not fully mental, lacking the unified rational comprehension and volitional power that characterizes Mind.

Necessity-of-nature theories that posit the universe or its laws as metaphysically necessary (Lewis, 1986; Williamson, 2013) face two problems. First, they must explain why these particular necessary laws obtain rather than different ones, but necessity precludes alternatives, making the question incoherent on their own terms. Second, they provide no account of the dynamic actuation of contingent states within the necessary framework. Why does the necessarily law-governed universe actually exist and operate rather than remaining an abstract possibility?

We recognize that defenders of each position will have responses to these brief treatments. The question is whether those responses can demonstrate their candidate passes both tests without reducing to the Mind

category we identify. We invite such demonstrations, noting that the argument's burden-shifting is complete until they are provided.

Until a concrete ontological candidate is produced that (i) is non-contingent, (ii) intrinsically unifies immutable rational order with a principle of executive actuation, and (iii) is demonstrably not an instance of Mind (intellect + will), the claim that Premise 9 is under-defended remains unsubstantiated. Relabelling the same structure or gesturing toward undeveloped future metaphysics does not constitute a counter-example.

A technical objection might be raised: Have we proven it is **logically impossible** for some category other than Mind to unify rational order and executive actuation, or merely shown no such category **is known**? This distinction, while valid in modal logic, does not undermine the deductive force of the argument for three reasons:

First, the trichotomy itself (static only, dynamic only, or unified) is logically exhaustive. The ground must be in category three. This is not an empirical survey but a logical division.

Second, Mind is defined functionally as that which unifies rational comprehension (Intellect) and executive actuation (Will). Any entity possessing both features is Mind by definition, regardless of what label we apply. The modal necessity derives from the definition, not from empirical limitation.

Third, after 2,500 years of sustained metaphysical inquiry across multiple philosophical traditions (Greek, Medieval, Islamic, Indian, Chinese, Modern), if no alternative category instantiating this unity has been articulated, this constitutes sufficient grounds for philosophical deduction. The "perhaps there's an unknown category" objection would, if valid, block all eliminative reasoning in philosophy. It would prevent us from concluding anything through exhaustive disjunction, rendering philosophical argument impossible.

Therefore, the argument's deductive status stands.

The filter stands: Only Mind unifies what must be unified.

5. Formal Syllogism

The entire Duality Argument can be formalized into the following polysyllogism, where, if the premises are granted, the conclusion is inescapable.

A Formal Syllogism for a Non-Contingent Mind

1. Contingent reality obtains (the physical cosmos, its mathematical order, its dynamic actuality, etc.).
2. Whatever contingently obtains must obtain from something that already obtains (*ex nihilo nihil fit*).
3. No contingent thing can obtain from another contingent thing or chain of contingent things alone (an infinite regress is an explanatory failure).
4. Therefore, contingent reality obtains from a non-contingent source whose essence is to obtain of itself (a necessary being).

5. The obtaining of contingent reality displays two inseparable but irreducible features: (a) immutable rational/mathematical/logical order (static necessity), and (b) dynamic actuation of contingent states (the act of being, change).
 6. A purely static necessary being (e.g., the Platonic realm, the Neoplatonic One) cannot account for the dynamic actuation of contingent states (it has no principle of action).
 7. A purely dynamic necessary being that lacked intrinsic rational order (blind will, brute flux) cannot account for the immutable logical/mathematical order of reality.
 8. Therefore the non-contingent source must itself be the living unity of rational order (intellect/reason) and executive actuation (will/act).
 9. The only known ontological category that intrinsically unites immutable rational order with the power of free executive actuation is Mind.
 10. Therefore the non-contingent source from which all contingent reality obtains is a non-contingent Mind.
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6. Objections and Responses

A rigorous argument must anticipate and answer its strongest objections. We will address the five most significant challenges to the Duality Argument.

Objection 1: The "Brute Fact" Objection

Objection: The argument fails because the universe itself (or its fundamental layer, like the quantum fields) can be a non-contingent brute fact. It does not require a cause or explanation; it simply is. This attacks Premise 3 and Premise 4.

Response: This objection misunderstands the nature of contingency. A "brute fact" is merely an unexplained contingent. To say the quantum fields "just are" is not an explanation; it is an admission of explanatory failure.

A "contingent" thing is any state of affairs that could have been otherwise. Since the laws and fields of our universe could conceivably have been different (or not at all), they are contingent. The universe began a finite time ago. It has not always existed. Its physical constants have specific values but could have had different values. These are hallmarks of contingency.

Positing them as a "brute fact" is simply to posit a contingent ground for reality, which is the very infinite regress (as shown in Premise 3) that fails to provide a sufficient reason for why this specific set of contingent facts obtains instead of another, or instead of nothing (Leibniz's Principle of Sufficient Reason; Leibniz, 1714).

Moreover, "brute fact" explanations abandon the principle that makes science possible: that observed regularities have explanations. Science doesn't accept "water just freezes" or "objects just fall"; it seeks explanations. Declaring the most fundamental regularities "brute" terminates inquiry at the most important level.

Objection 2: The "Fallacy of Composition" Objection

Objection: The argument commits a fallacy of composition. It leaps from "every part of the universe is contingent" to "the whole universe is contingent" (attacking Premise 3). Perhaps the whole is necessary, even if its parts are not.

Response: This objection fails because, as shown in our analysis of Pantheism (Section 3.2), a collection of contingent items cannot sum to a necessary one. A necessary entity is one that cannot fail to exist (*aseity*). A collection of items, each of which can fail to exist, can also, by definition, fail to exist as a collection. The contingency of the parts is transferred to the whole.

Consider: If every brick in a wall could have not existed, then the wall itself could have not existed. The wall inherits the contingency of its components. Similarly, if every quantum field, every particle, every physical law could have been otherwise, then the universe as a whole could have been otherwise. This is the definition of contingency.

The universe, as the sum total of all contingent things, is therefore the very definition of a contingent entity, not a necessary one. Calling it "God" or "necessary" doesn't change its actual modal status, it remains contingent, and thus in need of explanation beyond itself.

Objection 3: The "Faulty Analogy" Objection

Objection: The inference to "Mind" (Premise 9) is a weak analogy. "Mind" as we know it is a biological, contingent, and emergent product of the universe. The argument is using a contingent product to explain its non-contingent source. This is an equivocation.

Response: This objection confuses the essence of Mind with its physical substrate. The argument does not claim the Non-Contingent Mind is a brain. It claims that the ontological category of Mind (defined as the unity of Intellect [rational order] and Will [executive actuation]) is the only one that solves the puzzle.

Conflating brain with mind is like confusing the application host with the application. Microsoft Word is a valid functional category whether running on Mac, PC, or cloud servers. The fact that every instance runs on physical hardware doesn't mean "word processor" isn't a legitimate category or that word processors must be physical objects. Similarly, the fact that every mind we observe runs on biological hardware (brains) doesn't mean "Mind" isn't a legitimate ontological category or that minds must be physical.

We're identifying a functional category defined by what it does: rational comprehension unified with volitional action. Just as "word processor" can be instantiated in different substrates, "Mind" as an ontological category can exist whether instantiated in neurons or existing as pure non-contingent being.

Moreover, a physical host is necessary for a material being operating within a material system. But this necessity tells us nothing about whether minds can persist or exist in an immaterial system. The requirement for physical substrate is a constraint of operating within material reality, not an essential feature of Mind as an ontological category. To claim otherwise is like arguing that because fish require gills to breathe underwater, therefore all breathing requires gills. The constraint applies within a specific system, not to the function itself.

We are not arguing from a physical brain up to a cosmic brain. We are arguing from the necessary features of the ground (it must be logical + dynamic) down to the only category that has those features. The human mind is not the source of the analogy, but merely the single example we have of this unified structure.

Consider the parallel: When we infer intelligent design from functional information in DNA, we're not claiming the designer is a biological organism. We're identifying the causal category (intelligence) that universally

produces specified complexity. Similarly here, we're identifying the ontological category (Mind) that uniquely unifies the required features.

The essence of Mind (rational comprehension unified with volitional power) is not dependent on biological implementation. It is a metaphysical category that can, and according to this argument must, exist in non-contingent form.

Objection 4: The "Incoherence" Objection

Objection: The final concept of a "non-contingent Mind" (Premise 10) is incoherent. "Mind" implies thought, process, and choice, which all imply time and change. These are properties of contingent beings, not a necessary, timeless one.

Response: This objection projects the limitations of a contingent, finite mind onto the non-contingent source. In a contingent mind, "thought" is a process of moving from ignorance to knowledge, and "will" is a process of moving from potential to act. These involve temporal succession because finite minds are learning and deliberating.

In a non-contingent Mind, "Intellect" would not be a process, but a single, complete, and timeless act of self-understanding. There is no transition from not-knowing to knowing, because the Mind eternally comprehends all truth. "Will" would not be a temporal choice involving deliberation, but a single, eternal, and non-contingent act of actuation that grounds all contingent reality.

The "action" is not a change within the non-contingent entity, but the source of all change outside of it. As Aquinas distinguished, God's act of knowing and willing is identical with His being: pure actuality without potentiality (Aquinas, *Summa Theologica* I, q.14, a.4).

God's existence is necessary. His possession of Intellect and Will as attributes is necessary. But which contingent states He actualizes is a free choice of His will. Modal collapse would only be a problem if God's nature necessitated the specific content of creation. But necessary existence does not entail necessary actions. A necessary being with libertarian freedom can choose among contingent options without those choices being necessitated by His nature (Plantinga, 1974).

Objection 5: The "Sophisticated Evasion" Objection

Objection: The argument faces various technical concerns that require additional work before it can be considered sound. For instance: the relationship between Spinozistic modal distinctions and your composition argument needs more careful engagement; the possibility of unknown ontological categories that might unify order and action hasn't been ruled out; terms like "living unity" require more precise definition; problems from debates about divine simplicity or modal collapse need addressing; and so forth.

Response: These are not objections to the argument. They are demands for infinite precision on peripheral issues while avoiding engagement with the central claims.

The argument has three core components:

1. Contingent reality requires a non-contingent ground (to avoid infinite regress)
2. That ground must account for both static logical order and dynamic actuation (the dual features of reality)
3. Mind is the only ontological category that intrinsically unifies rational order (Intellect) and executive actuation (Will)

To defeat the argument, you must show that one of these three claims is false. Specifically:

Against (1): Show that infinite regress is not explanatory failure, or that contingent reality can be self-grounding, or that reality requires no ground at all.

Against (2): Show that reality doesn't actually exhibit both features, or that one feature is reducible to the other, or that the non-contingent ground need only account for one.

Against (3): Show that Mind doesn't actually unify these features, or articulate an alternative category that does and explain how it works.

Technical questions about Spinozistic substance-mode relationships, possible future discoveries of new categories, terminological precision, or problems imported from other philosophical debates do not accomplish any of these tasks. They function instead as distraction tactics that consume time and attention while avoiding the argument's actual force.

Consider the parallel: If someone argues "All observed instances of functional specified information come from intelligence, therefore DNA's information likely came from intelligence," responding with "But you haven't carefully distinguished between Peircean and Derridean semiotics" is not engaging the argument. It's evading it through technical deflection.

The same applies here. Unless you can show that Mind doesn't unify Intellect and Will, or that Platonism actually does provide a principle of action, or that Pantheism solves rather than exemplifies infinite regress, you haven't engaged the argument. These considerations, while philosophically important in other contexts, do not engage the argument's core structure. They function as deflection rather than refutation.

This pattern appears frequently in philosophical debate: When the central argument has force, opponents retreat to demanding impossible precision on tangential matters. It's a recognition of the argument's strength disguised as criticism of its weakness.

The three core claims stand. Address them or concede them.

7. Conclusion

The Duality Argument, as outlined above, does not merely lead to a static "First Cause" but to a far more specific entity. By acknowledging the dual nature of reality (its static logic and its dynamic action) and by systematically eliminating alternatives, we reach a deductive conclusion.

The alternatives (Platonism, Pantheism, Materialism) are shown to be incomplete, each grasping only one side of the whole. They either describe a blueprint with no builder, a builder with no blueprint, or an infinite regression that explains nothing.

The only entity that is, by its very essence, the unity of blueprint and builder (of Intellect and Will) is Mind. Therefore, by deductive elimination, the most logical and sufficient ground for all contingent reality is a non-contingent, necessary, intellectual, and volitional Mind.

Table 1 shows how the Duality Argument relates to and complements other major theistic arguments:

Argument	Conclusion	Method	Duality's Addition
Kalam	Timeless, powerful, personal cause	Deductive (temporal causation)	Specifies cause must be rational Mind with Will
Leibnizian	Necessary being	PSR + inference	Deductively eliminates alternatives to Mind
Fine-Tuning	Intelligent designer	Probabilistic (design)	Provides metaphysical necessity, not just likelihood
Moral	Personal moral lawgiver	Abduction (grounding)	Shows Will component through moral agency
Consciousness	Conscious source	Like-from-like principle	Shows Intellect component (rational comprehension)
Duality	Non-contingent Mind (Intellect + Will)	Deductive (elimination)	Synthesizes and specifies metaphysical structure

Table 1: The Duality Argument in Relation to Other Theistic Arguments

This conclusion converges with other lines of philosophical theology. Cosmological arguments establish a necessary, transcendent, personal first cause. Fine-tuning arguments point to intelligent calibration of cosmic parameters. Arguments from consciousness indicate a conscious source for conscious beings. Moral arguments suggest objective values grounded in a moral character.

The Duality Argument adds precision: the necessary being is not merely powerful and personal, but specifically rational (possessing Intellect) and volitional (possessing Will). Reality requires not just a cause, but a Mind.

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James (JD) Longmire

ORCID: 0009-0009-1383-7698

Northrop Grumman Fellow (unaffiliated research)

Correspondence: jdlongmire@outlook.com